

Take Full Responsibility: Replicating, Featuring Karen Hilton

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We've covered why modeling is so essential to taking full responsibility as a leader. The second key is replicating. Replicating involves actively coaching, mentoring, and sponsoring others within your organization to exhibit the behaviors that will lead to success. Replicating inspires curiosity and encourages commitment from others to practice the art of taking full responsibility.

So, as a leader, how do you initiate the practice of replicating? First, make sure responsibilities are clearly delineated and that everyone understands their role. The best way to handle responsibility is to break it down into smaller parts. Take care of one small thing at a time.

Second, empower your team. Equip people to make their own decisions and to own their piece of the equation.

Finally, a leader must create accountability. The leader must hold people accountable through self-reporting. Performance management systems that only engage people at scheduled times create kind of an obligatory performance that stifles creativity, innovation, ownership, and passion. It neutralizes the kind of responsibility that we know transforms individuals, teams, and organizations.

Pat (Summitt) was nothing if not a genius at holding people accountable, including herself. The more responsibility they're (your team members) given, the more committed they will be to a project, and the more they will make it their project. When it's theirs, they feel more accountable for its success or failure and they do whatever it takes to help it succeed. It becomes *our* team instead of *my* team.

What behaviors do you want your team members to replicate? Are you modeling those behaviors every day in ways both small and large? A culture of modeling and replicating success-oriented behaviors will help lead your team to the next level.